Python Chapter 2 Getting Started Activities

Contents

Python Chapter 2 Getting Started Activities 1
Practice, Practice, and More Practice – Neural Plasticity 1
Online Tutorials 2
Tutorial 1: Hello World 3
Tutorial 2: Band Name Creator 3
Requirements 3
Algorthym 4
Pseudocode 4
TODO 4
Tutorial 3: Inches to Centimeters 5
Input - Process - Output 7
Input 7
Process 7
Output 7
Tutorial 4: Susie's Square Calculator 8
Tutorial 5: Fun with Math 9
Assignment Submission 11

Time required: 90 minutes

Practice, Practice, and More Practice – Neural Plasticity

Practice makes permament.

We are going to provide you with a lot of information. You will need to put your brain in gear and write a lot of programs to retain the information. Very few people become expert athletes or musicians without a lot of practice. Similarly, very few people become expert programmers without a lot of practice.

A little bit of programming each day will strengthen the neural connections in your brain. Consistent daily practice literally re wires your brain. This is called **neural plasticity**.

If you want to learn to program, plan to spend a lot of time in front of your computer, not just reading, but programming as well.

Neural pathways are **strengthened** into habits through the repetition and practice of thinking, feeling, and acting.

PRACTICE: Start your morning passionately declaring aloud your goals for the day. Declarations send the power of your subconscious mind on a mission to find solutions to fulfill your goals.

Online Tutorials

Go through the following tutorials.

- LearnPython.org Hello World
- LearnPython.org Variables and Types
- Python Introduction
- Python Get Started
- Python Syntax
- Python Comments
- Python Variables
    - Variable Names
    - Assign Multiple Values
    - Output Variables
    - Global Variables
- Python Data Types
- Python Numbers
- Python Casting
- Python Strings
- Python Operators
- Python User Input

Tutorial 1: Hello World

Hello World is the traditional first program to create in any programming language. It confirms that your programming environment is setup properly.

Create a Python program file called **hello_world.py**

Let's create this program in the style we will use for this class.

1. Type in the following code.

```
"""
    Name: hello_world.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: My first Python program
"""
```

This is a header for the program. It is a multiline comment letting whoever is reading the code know what the program is about. Python ignores comments.

```
# Print the literal string Hello World!
print("Hello Python World! Let's start coding!!")
```

- The first line is a comment about what the second line does.
- The second line prints text to the console.

Example run:

```
Hello Python World! Let's start coding!!
```

Tutorial 2: Band Name Creator

Let's create a program that gets input from the user. Who doesn't want a cool band name?

Requirements

We are going to go through a development process to create a program that takes two string inputs from the user and assembles those inputs into a Band Nane.

Algorthym

Every program you write solves some type of program. An algorithm is the method of solving that problem.

Pseudocode

Pseudocode is one way of planning out your program in simple natural language.

Pseudocode is the first step of translating the algorithm to the programming language. The more you figure out before you code, the easier it is to code an efficient and elegant program. An elegant, simple program is like a work of art.

```
Create a greeting for your program.
Ask the user for the city that they grew up in.
Ask the user for the name of a pet.
Combine the name of their city and pet.
Display their band name.
```

TODO

A **TODO** list is another way to plan out your program.

```
# Anything after the # sign is a comment. Python ignores this line.
```

Copy and paste the following code to get started with this program.

```
# TODO: Create a greeting for your program.

# TODO: Ask the user for the city that they grew up in.

# TODO: Ask the user for the name of a pet.

# TODO: Combine the name of their city and pet.

# TODO: Display the band name.
```

1. Create a Python program named: **band_name_generator.py**
2. Type in the following code.

```
"""
    Name: band_name_generator.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: Get string inputs from user, concatenate them together
"""
```

This is a multiline comment that describes the program.

```
# TODO: Ask the user for the city that they grew up in.
city = input("What's the name of a city you grew up in: ")

# TODO: Ask the user for the name of a pet.
pet = input("What's your pet's name: ")
```

Get two string inputs into two string variables from the user. A variable is a named storage location in dynamic memory or RAM.

```
# TODO: Combine the name of their city and pet.
# Display the their band name.
print("Your band name is: " + city + " " + pet)
```

String concatenation refers to the process of combining multiple strings into a single string. This can be achieved using the **+** operator. If a variable is involved, it is converted to a string.

Example run:

```
What's the name of a city you grew up in: Welcome
What's your pet's name: Goldie
Your band name is: Welcome Goldie
```

Tutorial 3: Inches to Centimeters

Getting numeric input from the user involves another method of input. All input from the keyboard comes in as a string. To convert the string to a number we use the **float()** or **int()** function.

The **float()** function in Python converts a number or a string that represents a floating-point number into a floating-point value. It returns a floating-point number, allowing numeric operations with decimal points.

```
# Get string input from the user
inches = input("Enter inches: ")
# Convert a string to a float number like 3.114
inches = float(inches)
```

In Python, we typically combine both of those operations in a single line.

```
# Get a string from the user, store a decimal number in the inches variable
inches = float(input("Enter inches: "))
```

Copy and paste the following code to get started with this program.

```
"""
    Name: inches_to_centimeters.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: Convert Inches to Centimeters
"""

# TODO: Print a nice title for our program

# TODO: Get inches input from user, cast to float

# TODO: Convert inches to centimeters

# TODO: Display the centimeter result
```

1. Create a new Python program named **inches_to_cm.py**.
2. Type in the following code.

```
1   """
2       Name: inches_to_centimeters.py
3       Author:
4       Created:
5       Purpose: Convert Inches to Centimeters
6   """
```

This is a multiline comment that gives information about the program. It is helpful to have a descriptive header in a program.

```
8   # TODO: Print a nice title for our program
9   print("-----------------------------------------")
10  print("|     Inches to Centimeters Converter     |")
11  print("-----------------------------------------")
```

The first line is a single comment to let another programmer know what is going on.

The next lines print the program title to the console.

Input - Process - Output

All programs have three basic components.

Input

```
# TODO: Get inches input from user, cast to float
inches = float(input("Enter inches: "))
```

The first line is a comment describing what happens in the second line.

The next line is an input function. Its job is to ask the user to type something in and to capture what the user types. The part in quotes is the prompt that the user sees. It is called a string and will appear to the program's user exactly as it appears in the code itself.

We use the **float()** funciton to convert the incoming string to a float.

We use the assignment operator **=** to assign the float value to the **inches** variable.

Process

The process section is where the program does a calculation of some kind.

```
# TODO: Convert inches to centimeters
centimeters = inches * 2.54
```

This line uses the standard math formula to convert centimeters to inches. Notice that the = is different in programming than in math. It is called the assignment statement. The calculations or values on the right are assigned to the variable on the left.

Output

```
# TODO: Display the centimeter result
print(inches + " inches is equal to " + centimeters + " centimeters.")
```

The last line uses the print function to print out the conversion result. Note the + sign between the variable names and the strings. That is called concatenation. Concatenation turns everything into a string.

1. Run the program by pressing the F5 key.
2. The program will ask you to Enter inches. Type in 24 and press enter.

Example run:

```
-----------------------------------------
|     Inches to Centimeters Converter     |
-----------------------------------------
Enter inches: 24
24.0 inches is equal to 60.96 centimeters.
```

This program may seem too short and simple to be of much use. There are many websites that do similar conversions. Their code is not much more complicated than the code here.

Tutorial 4: Susie's Square Calculator

Let's calculate the area and perimeter of a square.

1. Create a Python program named **square_calculator.py**

You can pseudocode your code by using a TODO list as shown below. This allows you to plan and start commenting your code.

2. Copy and paste the following to start your program.

```
"""
    Name: square_calculator.py
    Author: William A Loring
    Created: 07/08/22
    Purpose: Calculate the area and perimeter of a square
"""

# TODO: Print a creative title for our program

# TODO: Get side and length from user, cast to float

# TODO: Calculate area

# TODO: Calculate perimeter
```

```
# TODO: Display results
```

3. Enter the following code.

```python
"""
    Name: square_calculator.py
    Author: William A Loring
    Created: 07/08/22
    Purpose: Calculate the area and perimeter of a square
"""

# TODO: Print a nice title for our program
print("--------------------------------")
print("|  Susie's Square Calculator   |")
print("--------------------------------")

# TODO: Get side length from user, cast to float
side = float(input("Enter the length of a side: "))

# TODO: Calculate area
area = side * side

# TODO: Calculate perimeter
perimeter = side * 4

# TODO: Display results
print(f"Area:      {area}")
print(f"Perimeter: {perimeter}")
```

Example run:

```
--------------------------------
|  Susie's Square Calculator   |
--------------------------------
Enter the length of a side: 21.2
Area:      449.44
Perimeter: 84.8
```

Tutorial 5: Fun with Math

This tutorial shows some of the common math operations and math library functions. (+-*/ are not included.)

```python
"""
    Name: fun_with_math.py
    Author: William A Loring
    Created: 08/01/22
    Purpose: Python math demonstration
"""

import math
import random
print(45 * "-")
print("-------------   Fun with Math   -------------")
print(45 * "-")

print("Modulus of 45: ", end="")
print(45 % 2)

print("Integer division 65 // 9: ", end="")
print(65 // 9)

print("Max of 3 and 5: ", end="")
print(max(3, 5))

print("Min of 3 and 5: ", end="")
print(min(3, 5))

print("Value of pi in Python: ", end="")
print(math.pi)

print("Square root of 4: ", end="")
print(math.sqrt(4))

print("4 to the power of 10: ", end="")
print(4**10)

print("Absolute value of -5: ", end="")
absolute_value = abs(-5)
print(absolute_value)

print("Rounded to 2 decimal points: ",  end="")
print(round(20.0 / 3.0, 2))

print("Rounded up to int: ",  end="")
print(math.ceil(20.0 / 3.0))

print("Rounded down to int: ",  end="")
print(math.floor(20.0 / 3.0))

print("Rounded to 4 decimal points: ", end="")
rounded = round((20.0 * 100.0 / 3.0) / 100.0, 4)
print(rounded)

print("Random integer between 1 and 6 inclusive: ", end="")
print(random.randint(1, 6))
```

Example run:

```
---------------------------------------------
-------------   Fun with Math   -------------
---------------------------------------------
Modulus of 45: 1
Integer division 65 // 9: 7
Max of 3 and 5: 5
Min of 3 and 5: 3
Value of pi in Python: 3.141592653589793
Square root of 4: 2.0
4 to the power of 10: 1048576
Absolute value of -5: 5
Rounded to 2 decimal points: 6.67
Rounded up to int: 7
Rounded down to int: 6
Rounded to 4 decimal points: 6.6667
Random integer between 1 and 6 inclusive: 1
```

Assignment Submission

1. Attach the pseudocode.
2. Attach the program files.
3. Attach screenshots showing the successful operation of the program.
4. Submit in Blackboard.